

# Lost in TRANSITION

As it meanders from one crisis to another, the BJP remains crippled by the lack of a cogent leadership to revive its fortunes. The saffron script is coming undone.

by P. SHIVA MURARI KISHAN



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Things fall apart; the centre cannot hold. What W.B. Yeats wrote more than 90 years ago quite appropriately sums up the crisis that has engulfed the BJP where nothing ever goes the way of intended consequence. The meeting of the party's National Executive at Patna last week was aimed to show that the JD(U)-BJP alliance that has been in power for nearly five years in the state remains strong as ever. It ended up pushing the two allies to the edge of disaster.

The Patna meet was the first under the presidentship of Nitin Gadkari and expectations were high. The venue had been chosen with great care in view

of assembly elections in the state, four months from now. The two-day meeting over the weekend was to culminate in a huge joint rally with the JD(U) that was supposed to send electoral shivers down the spines of opponents ranging from Lalu Prasad Yadav to Ram Vilas Paswan and the

**BHARATI AND JASWANT ARE BEING LURED BACK TO THE BJP AFTER THEIR EXPULSION**

Congress. But Chief Minister Nitish Kumar, famous for flaunting his secular credentials even as he stays in power in alliance with the BJP, refused to attend the rally, cancelled a dinner he was to host for the visitors and took objection to BJP posters that showed him in the company of his Gujarat counterpart Narendra Modi. All because he wants his share of the minority vote.

Nothing went according to the script and instead of strengthening the alliance, the National Executive members left Patna with the alliance on the brink of a divorce. "The party members are not behaving like seasoned politicians but like political greenhorns," said a senior party leader.

It is almost comical the way



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